The State of Windows Support in Fluent Bit

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Fluentd Meetup

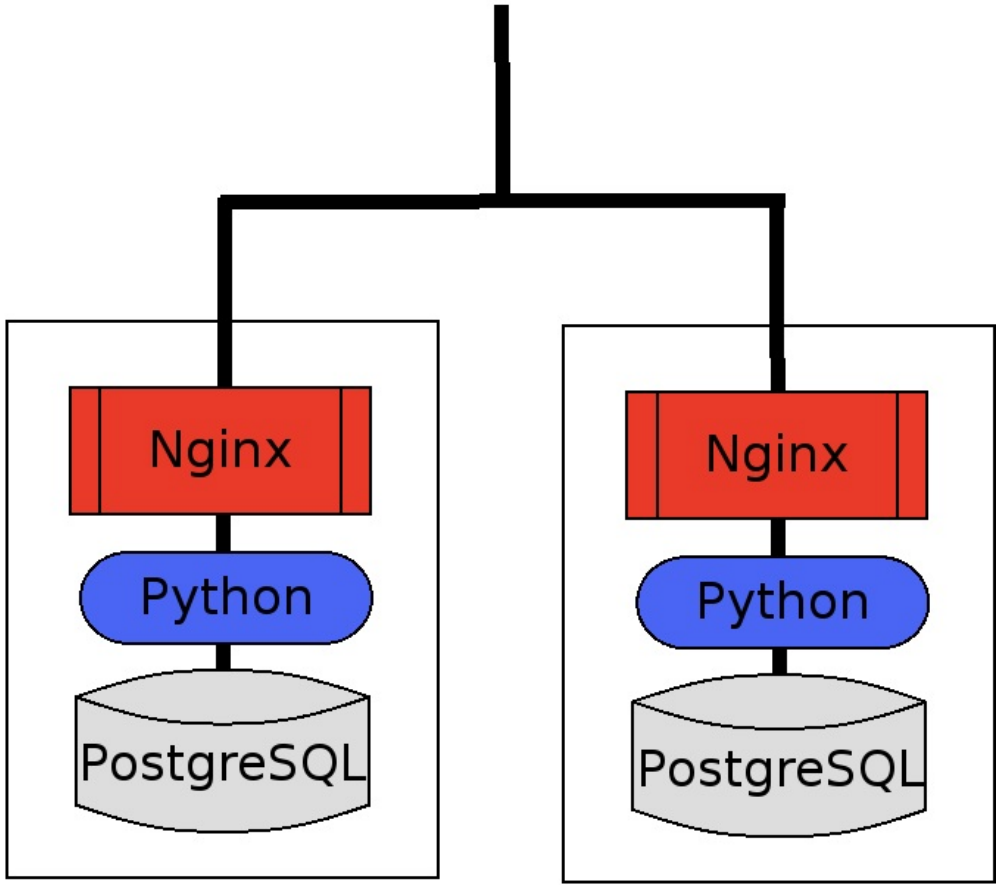
Talk Agenda

1. Higher overview of Fluent Bit
2. The state of Windows support
3. The future of development

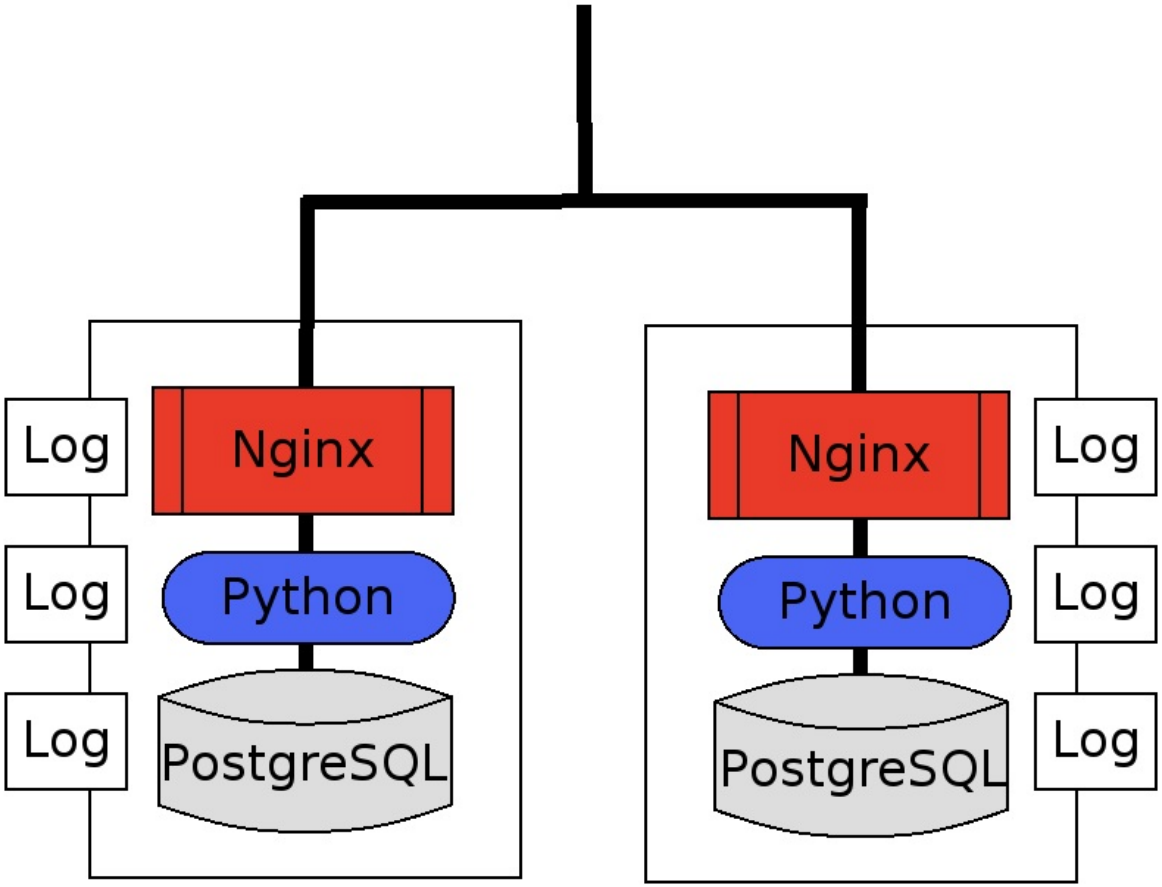
Higher Overview

"Log Management Problem"

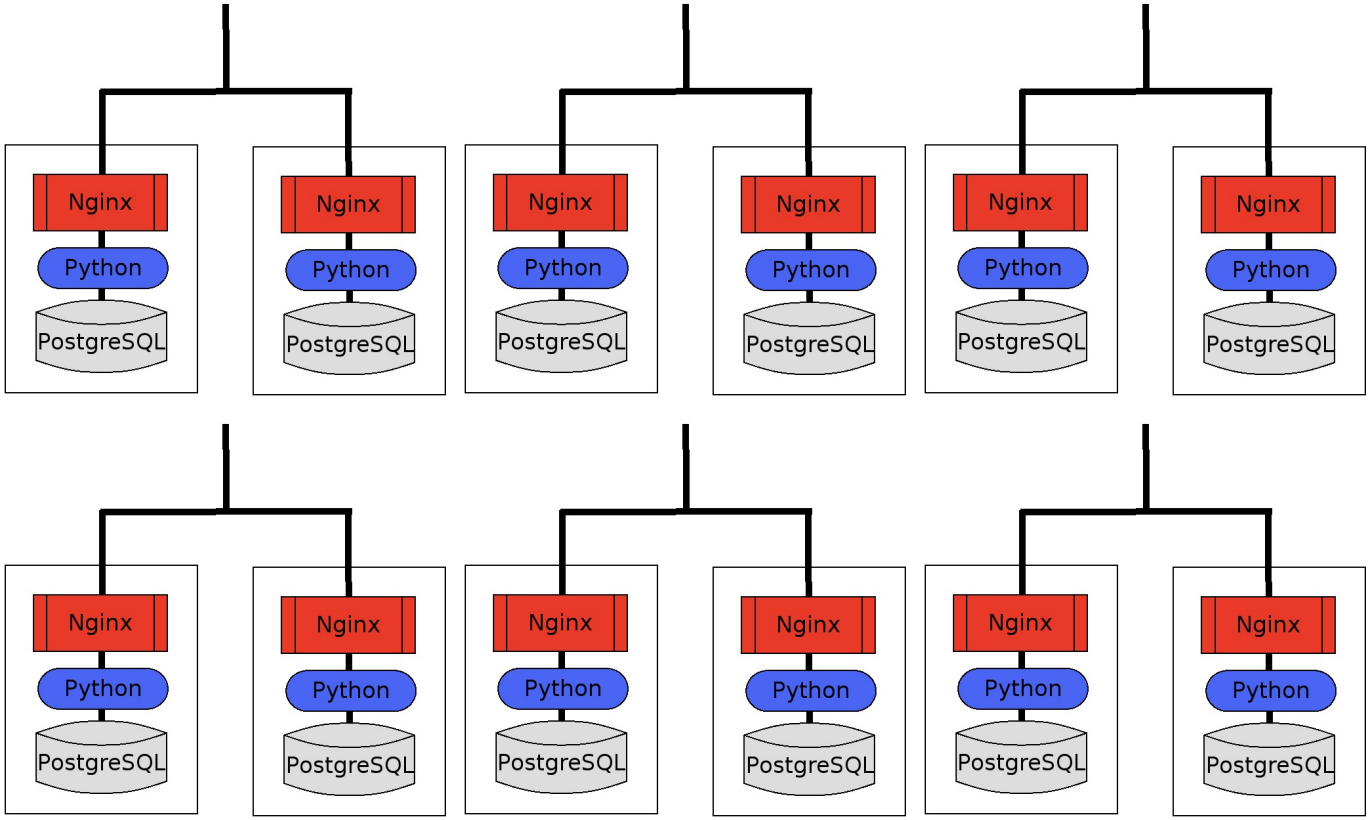
Traditional Web application Stack



Traditional Web application Stack



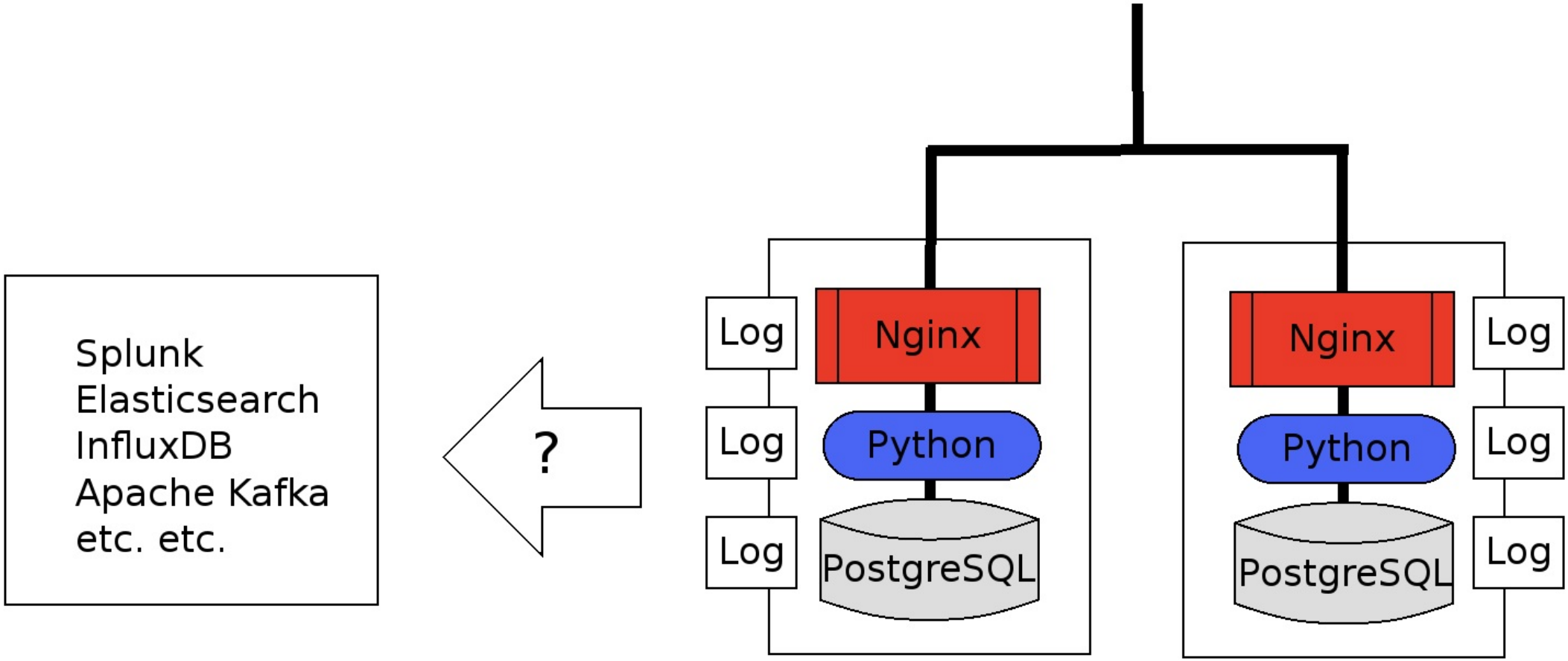
Age of Micro Services



Rise of Log Management Solutions

- Splunk
- Elasticsearch + Kibana
- InfluxDB
- Apache Kafka
- etc. etc.

Remaining Problems



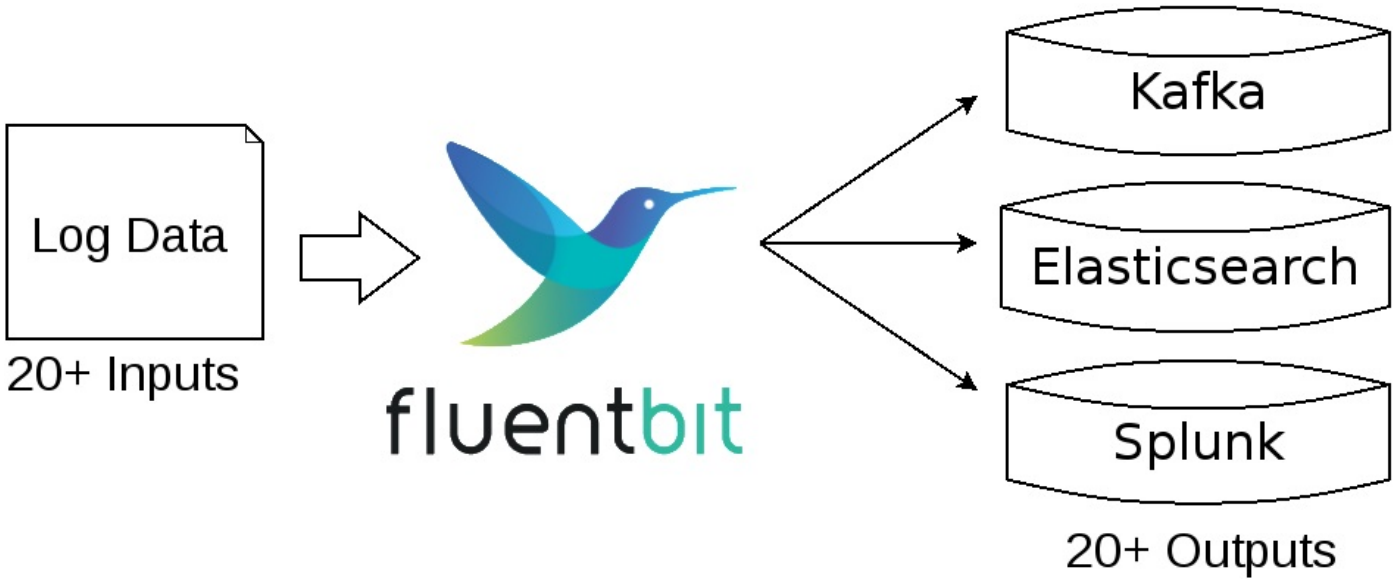
Summary (so far)

- You have a large amount of log data.
- You have amazing log management solutions.
- What's missing is a pipeline to connect them.

Solution

Fluent Bit Overview

Use Fluent Bit to connect services

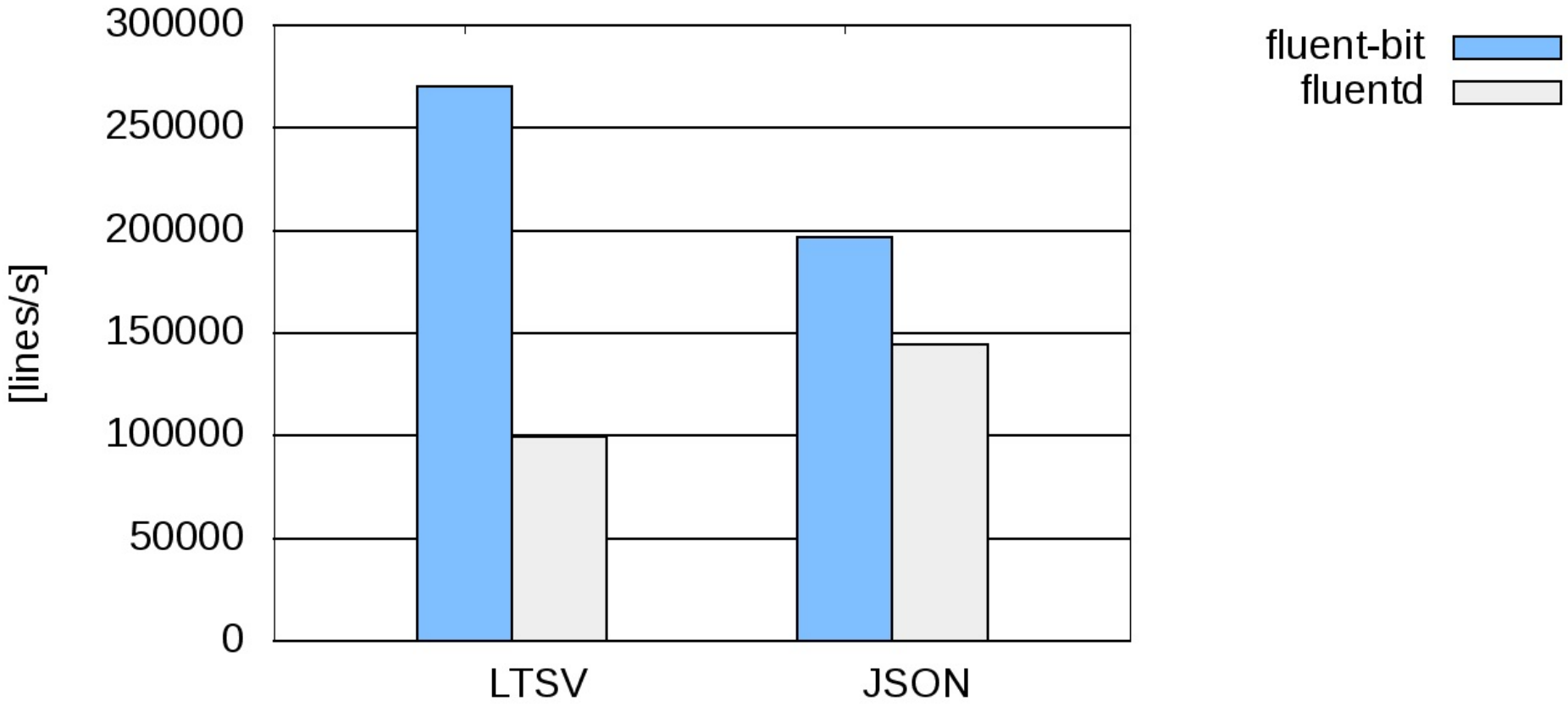


What is the difference with Fluentd?

fluentd

fluentbit

Processed Lines Per Second (the higher the better)



(Measured on Intel Core i7-8700T on Debian)

Summary (so far)

- Fluent Bit is a log shipper.
- It can transfer your logs to a number of services.
- It's very efficient thanks to C.

State of Windows Support

"Evolving of Fluent Bit"

Five years ago (2014)

"Fluent Bit is a collection tool designed for Embedded Linux that collects Kernel messages and Hardware metrics"

... From README.md at b327996bfc

Evolving of Fluent Bit

- **2015** "Fluent Bit is an events collector for *Linux, Embedded Linux, OSX and BSD*"
- **2017** "Native *aarch64* support has been merged."
- **2019** "Starting from this version we are supporting builds on *Windows environments*"

State of Windows support

- Windows Project Start = 2018/12
    - Done porting most of the core engine.
    - 1/3 of plugins are working.
- Early stage, but it's already usable.

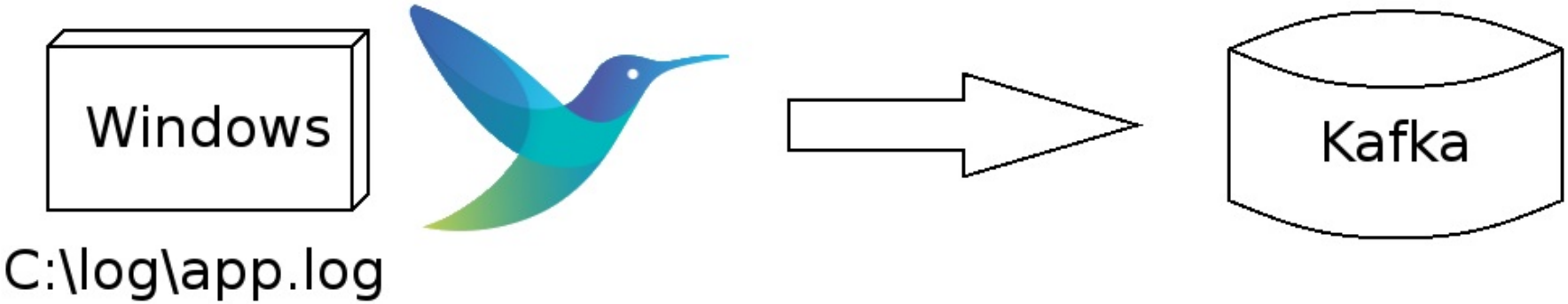
The achievement so far

- Enable to compile Fluent Bit on Microsoft Visual C.
- Can launch Fluent Bit on PowerShell (or cmd.exe)
- Done porting 20 plugins
- Installers are also available (EXE and ZIP)

Step-by-step Tutorial

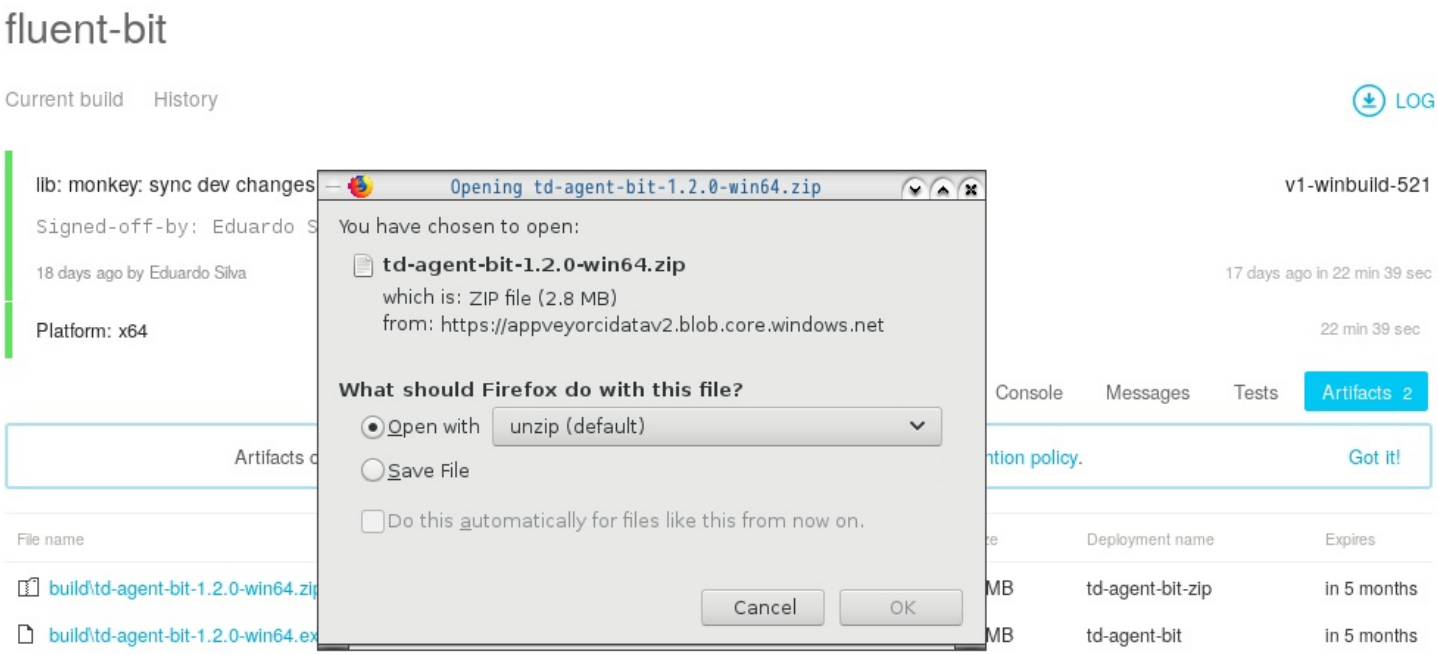
"How you can use Fluent Bit"

The task



Tutorial

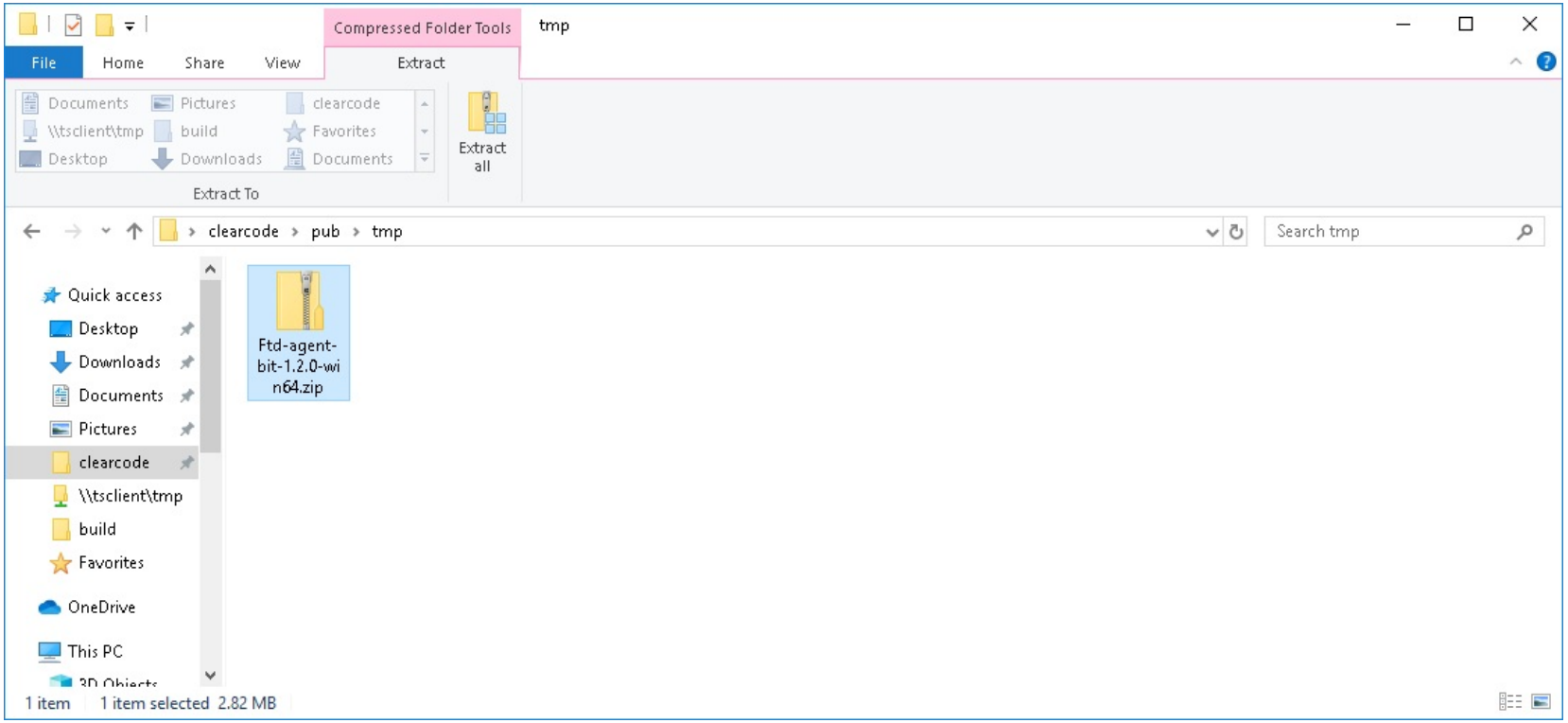
1. Download a ZIP installer for Windows.



https://ci.appveyor.com/project/fluent/fluent-bit-2e87g/history

Tutorial

2. Unzip the ZIP archive



Tutorial

3. Launch Fluent Bit from PowerShell

```
PS> bin\fluent-bit.exe -i tail
                       -p path=C:\logs\app.log
                       -o kafka
                       -p brokers=192.168.100.1
                       -p topics=windows
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Tutorial

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Summary: How to run Fluent Bit

1. Download the ZIP archive
2. Unzip it
3. Run the fluent-bit

The Future

Some Ideas

- Expand Plugin Support
- Windows Event Log Plugin (ongoing)
- More document & guides

We need feedbacks from users!

- Tell us on the issue tracker!
- https://github.com/fluent/fluent-bit